ICE COCOA FUTURES (CC)

"NYBOT Cocoa" — Spread & Curve Structure Fundamental Reference

US Dollar-Denominated Cocoa, and Its Relationship to London Cocoa

This document presents a fact-based reference on the fundamental drivers of ICE Cocoa futures (ticker: CC), the USD-denominated cocoa contract still commonly referred to by market participants as "NYBOT Cocoa" after its originating exchange, the New York Board of Trade (NYBOT, formerly the Coffee, Sugar & Cocoa Exchange, CSCE). NYBOT merged into the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) in 2007, and the contract now trades as ICE Cocoa (CC) on ICE Futures US, though the legacy name remains in routine use among traders. CC is one of two major global cocoa futures benchmarks; the other is London Cocoa (ticker XC, ICE Futures Europe, GBP-denominated), which was the subject of a separate reference document produced earlier in this series. Because the two contracts share the same underlying global supply chain (West African origin, the same disease and weather risks, the same ICCO and grindings data), this document presents the New York-specific fundamentals in full, and includes a dedicated, fact-only comparison section addressing every material structural and operational difference between the two contracts.

Futures First — Internal Education Material
For Analyst Group Use

1. Contract Specifications and Delivery Mechanics

ICE Cocoa (CC) is a physically delivered contract for cocoa beans delivered into licensed warehouses in the United States and at specified European/Atlantic ports. It is the dollar-denominated complement to the sterling-denominated London contract, and the two together constitute the global cocoa futures price-discovery mechanism.

Parameter	Detail
Exchange	ICE Futures US (the former New York Board of Trade / NYBOT, itself formed from the 1998 merger of the Coffee, Sugar & Cocoa Exchange, CSCE, with the New York Cotton Exchange; ICE acquired NYBOT in 2007)
Ticker	CC (front month); commonly still called "NYBOT Cocoa" or simply "New York cocoa"
Contract size	10 metric tonnes
Quotation	US dollars per metric tonne (USD/MT); minimum tick = $1.00/MT = $10.00 per contract
Contract months	March (H), May (K), July (N), September (U), December (Z) — five delivery months per year, the same calendar structure as London Cocoa. Liquid trading concentrated in the front 3–4 contracts.
Settlement type	Physical delivery via warehouse receipt at ICE-licensed warehouses in the United States (historically New York/New Jersey port area warehouses) and at certain European delivery points; graded and certified by ICE-approved graders.
Delivery grade	"Good fermented" cocoa from a list of approved growths/origins, each assigned a premium or discount differential to the base contract grade reflecting bean size, defect count, and origin quality reputation.
Last trading day	Approximately 11 business days prior to the last business day of the delivery month
Trading hours	ICE electronic: Sunday–Friday 21:30–14:00 ET (approx.); most liquid 08:00–12:30 ET
Contract value at $7,000/MT	$70,000 per contract
Relationship to London Cocoa	London Cocoa (XC, ICE Futures Europe, GBP/tonne) is the sister contract. The two are highly correlated but trade in different currencies, against different origin-differential schedules, and with different delivery point geography. See Section 10 for a complete, fact-only comparison.

1.1 Origin Eligibility and Differentials

- As with London Cocoa, the CC contract permits delivery of cocoa from a defined list of approved growths, each carrying a differential (premium or discount in USD/MT) relative to the contract base grade. The exchange periodically reviews and adjusts these differentials to reflect prevailing quality assessments and changes in physical market premiums for specific origins.
- **Ivory Coast and Ghana** are eligible growths and, consistent with their dominant share of global production, represent the largest share of cocoa typically delivered and held in certified stock against the CC contract.
- **Additional eligible origins** historically include Nigeria, Cameroon, Ecuador, and other approved growths; the specific list and associated differentials are published and maintained by ICE and are subject to periodic revision.

1.2 Delivery Point Geography

- CC-deliverable warehouses are located in the United States (historically concentrated in the New York/New Jersey port area, reflecting the contract's origin as a New York-based market) as well as at certain European delivery points recognised by the exchange, allowing some flexibility in physical settlement location. This is distinct from London Cocoa, whose certified warehouses are concentrated in continental European and UK ports (see Section 10.3 for the full comparison).

2. Global Production — The Supply Landscape

The underlying physical cocoa market priced by CC is the same global cocoa supply chain priced by London Cocoa: approximately 70% of world cocoa production is concentrated in West Africa, with Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana together accounting for the majority of global output. Because this production geography, the crop calendar, and the weather and disease risk factors are identical regardless of which exchange is used to price the crop, this section summarises the same core production facts established in the London Cocoa reference document; the analysis is not duplicated origin-by-origin here.

Origin	Approx. Share of World Supply	Crop Calendar	Key Structural Facts
Côte d'Ivoire	~40–45%	Main crop Oct–Mar; mid-crop Apr–Sep	World's largest producer. Conseil du Café-Cacao (CCC) manages export tax (DUS) and farmgate price guarantees.
Ghana	~15–20%	Main crop Oct–Mar (slight lag vs Côte d'Ivoire); mid-crop Apr–Sep	Second-largest producer. COCOBOD is sole legal buyer/exporter; manages forward sales programme and CSSV eradication campaigns.
Ecuador	~6–8%, growing	Harvest spread across the year, two seasonal peaks	Significant and growing producer of fine-flavour and CCN-51 (high-yield) cocoa; growing share of global exports.
Cameroon, Nigeria	~6–8% combined	Main crop Oct–Mar	Secondary West African origins; contribute to the regional weather/disease risk pool.
Indonesia, other Asia/Pacific	~4–6% combined	Varies	Bulk-grade cocoa; historically more relevant to industrial/bulk demand than to fine-flavour markets.

The cocoa crop year (used by the ICCO and most trade statistics) runs October 1 – September 30, aligned with the start of the West African main crop. Within this year, West Africa produces two harvests: the main crop (October–March, approximately 70–75% of annual volume) and the mid-crop (April–September, approximately 25–30%). This biannual structure, and the certified stock and weather/disease dynamics built on top of it, are described in full in the London Cocoa reference document and apply identically to the physical market underlying CC.

3. Demand — Grindings, with a North American Focus

Grindings (the processing of cocoa beans into liquor, butter, and powder) are the standard demand-side measure for the cocoa market, published quarterly on a regional basis. Because CC is the contract most directly used by North American market participants for hedging and price discovery, this section places additional emphasis on the North American grindings data and demand structure relative to the global picture already covered for London Cocoa.

3.1 Regional Grindings Reports

Region	Publisher	Frequency	Relevance to CC
North America	National Confectioners Association (NCA)	Quarterly	The most directly relevant grindings report for CC, as it measures the demand base most closely tied to the US dollar-denominated contract and US/Canadian confectionery and food manufacturing.
Europe	European Cocoa Association (ECA)	Quarterly	The largest single grindings region globally; relevant to CC as a global demand indicator, and directly relevant to the London contract.
Asia-Pacific	Cocoa Association of Asia (CAA)	Quarterly	Smaller but growing grindings region; relevant to both contracts as a global demand growth indicator.

3.2 US and Canadian Confectionery and Food Manufacturing Demand

- US cocoa and chocolate demand is driven by the confectionery manufacturing sector (chocolate bars, baking chocolate, cocoa powder for beverages and baked goods) and by the food service and retail bakery sector's use of cocoa-derived ingredients. Major US confectionery manufacturers and food companies are end-users whose purchasing and hedging activity is conducted substantially through the CC contract given its USD denomination.
- **Seasonal demand patterns in North America**: US chocolate confectionery demand exhibits seasonal peaks around major gifting and holiday occasions (Valentine's Day, Easter, Halloween, and the year-end holiday season), creating a recurring pattern of manufacturer forward purchasing and inventory building ahead of these dates. This seasonal manufacturing/purchasing rhythm is a North America-specific demand consideration that does not have a precise equivalent in the European demand calendar, though European confectionery demand has its own holiday-linked seasonal pattern (e.g., around Easter).
- **Cocoa butter and cocoa powder balance**: grinding cocoa beans yields both cocoa butter (used in chocolate manufacturing and, separately, in cosmetics and pharmaceuticals) and cocoa powder (used in beverages, baking, and food manufacturing). The relative demand for butter versus powder — driven separately by chocolate confectionery demand on one side and beverage/bakery demand on the other — affects the economics of grinding operations and is tracked via the "cocoa butter ratio" and "cocoa powder ratio" (the price of each product expressed as a multiple of the bean price), published by industry trade sources.

3.3 US Customs and Trade Data

- US Census Bureau and US Department of Agriculture (USDA) trade data provide US-specific cocoa bean, cocoa butter, and cocoa powder import statistics, offering a complementary, US-specific demand data series alongside the quarterly NCA grindings figures.

4. Currency Dynamics — USD Denomination

Because CC is denominated and settled in US dollars, its currency exposure profile differs from London Cocoa in a specific and important way: CC removes the GBP exposure layer that exists in the London contract, while remaining exposed to the same West African producer-currency dynamics that affect both contracts.

4.1 No GBP Cross for CC Itself

- Unlike London Cocoa, where the GBP/USD exchange rate is a direct and continuously relevant variable (because the contract is priced in GBP while the underlying physical cocoa trade is conducted globally in USD), the CC contract is itself denominated in USD, eliminating this particular currency layer for participants trading CC outright or in CC calendar spreads.
- This does not mean CC is currency-neutral: it remains fully exposed to the West African producer-currency dynamics described below, which affect the underlying physical cocoa supply regardless of which exchange and currency the futures price is denominated in.

4.2 West African CFA Franc (XOF) — The Shared Exposure

- Both Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana's neighbouring CFA franc zone countries use the West African CFA franc (XOF), which is pegged to the euro. (Ghana itself uses its own currency, the Ghanaian cedi, GHS, which floats rather than being pegged.) XOF/EUR peg stability affects farmer income predictability in Côte d'Ivoire and the CFA franc zone, while EUR/USD movements affect the USD-equivalent income farmers receive when the global cocoa price is set in USD terms (as it effectively is, via the CC contract and the USD basis used in physical cocoa trade generally) but their costs and reference prices are partly euro-linked.
- **Ghanaian cedi (GHS)**: as a floating currency, GHS depreciation against the USD increases the cedi-equivalent revenue Ghanaian farmers and COCOBOD receive at a given USD cocoa price, a dynamic analogous to the BRL effect described in the sugar and coffee reference documents for Brazilian farmers, though operating through Ghana's specific cedi exchange rate rather than BRL.

4.3 EUR/USD as a Shared Cross-Market Variable

- EUR/USD remains relevant to CC despite CC's own USD denomination, because: (1) it affects Côte d'Ivoire/CFA zone farmer and exporter economics via the XOF/EUR peg as described above, and (2) it affects the relative cost competitiveness of European grinding operations purchasing cocoa in USD terms, which is relevant to both the CC and XC demand pictures.

5. Government Policy and Export Taxes

The government policy variables affecting cocoa supply are common to both CC and London Cocoa, since both contracts price the same underlying West African physical market. This section restates the core policy mechanisms for completeness within this document.

5.1 Côte d'Ivoire — DUS Export Tax and Farmgate Pricing

- **Droit Unique de Sortie (DUS)**: Côte d'Ivoire's export tax on cocoa, set and periodically adjusted by the Conseil du Café-Cacao (CCC). Changes in the DUS rate directly affect exporter netback economics and can influence the pace of forward sales and export commitments.
- **Farmgate price guarantee**: the CCC sets a guaranteed minimum price paid to farmers each season, funded in part through forward sales of the crop conducted by the CCC ahead of and during the season. This forward-selling programme creates a visible, programmatic source of deferred-month selling pressure, trackable in commercial positioning data.

5.2 Ghana — COCOBOD as Sole Buyer/Exporter

- Ghana's Cocoa Board (COCOBOD) operates as the sole legal buyer and exporter of Ghanaian cocoa, setting the domestic producer price and managing the country's forward hedging programme (historically pre-selling a substantial majority of the expected crop ahead of the season). COCOBOD also runs Ghana's long-running Cocoa Swollen Shoot Virus (CSSV) eradication and replanting programme, a structural factor affecting Ghana's longer-run production trajectory (see the London Cocoa reference document for the full disease-risk discussion, which applies identically here).

5.3 Why This Section Is Identical in Substance to the London Document

Because Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana export their cocoa into a single global physical market regardless of which futures exchange is used for price discovery and hedging, a DUS change, a farmgate price adjustment, or a COCOBOD forward-sales decision affects the supply available to both CC and XC simultaneously and to the same degree. There is no policy lever available to either government that discriminates between the New York and London cocoa markets.

6. Weather and Disease Risk

As with government policy, the weather and disease risk factors affecting cocoa supply are shared in full between CC and XC, since both price the same West African (and broader global) physical crop. This section summarises these shared risk factors for completeness.

Risk Factor	Mechanism	Affected Period/Contracts	Shared Across CC and XC?
Harmattan wind (Nov–Feb)	Dry, dusty Saharan wind. Moderate Harmattan aids bean drying; severe Harmattan causes pod dehydration and can damage mid-crop flowering.	Mid-crop sizing (Apr–Sep harvest, affecting contracts referencing that period)	Yes — identical physical mechanism
El Niño / ENSO drought	Reduced West African rainfall historically associated with below-average main crop production.	Back-curve contracts (multi-season supply outlook)	Yes — identical physical mechanism
La Niña / excess rainfall	Above-average rainfall; raises black pod disease risk while generally supporting crop volume.	Main crop season (Oct–Dec) quality and yield	Yes — identical physical mechanism
Black pod disease (Phytophthora palmivora)	Fungal disease thriving in wet, humid conditions; can destroy a significant share of a crop in severe outbreaks.	Front contracts — an active outbreak alert is a near-term physical supply signal	Yes — identical physical mechanism
Cocoa Swollen Shoot Virus (CSSV)	Mealybug-transmitted, no cure; infected trees must be removed, a multi-year structural supply constraint, particularly significant in Ghana.	Back curve — multi-year structural supply trajectory	Yes — identical physical mechanism

The full discussion of these weather and disease mechanisms — including historical episodes and quantitative thresholds where available — is presented in the London Cocoa reference document and applies without modification to the physical market underlying CC.

7. ICCO Data and the Stocks-to-Grindings Ratio

The International Cocoa Organization (ICCO) publishes the authoritative quarterly and annual global supply/demand balance sheet covering world production, grindings, and end-of-season stocks, expressed on the same October–September crop year basis used throughout the cocoa trade. This data is exchange-agnostic: the ICCO does not separately report a "CC-specific" or "XC-specific" balance, because both contracts price the same global physical market.

- **Stocks-to-grindings (S/G) ratio**: end-of-season global stocks expressed as a percentage of annual grindings — the key single metric for assessing overall market tightness. A low S/G ratio (historically associated with sustained backwardation) and a high S/G ratio (associated with contango) affect both CC and XC forward curve shape, since both curves price the same global physical scarcity or abundance.
- **World production estimates**: published quarterly, with the earliest main-crop estimates (October–November) carrying the widest uncertainty bands and the greatest potential to move prices on deviation from consensus, equally for CC and XC.

7.1 Certified Stocks — Where CC and XC Diverge Operationally

- While the ICCO's global balance sheet is shared, the day-to-day **certified warehouse stock data** published by each exchange is specific to that exchange's own delivery system and warehouses, and is not identical between CC and XC. CC certified stocks reflect cocoa held in ICE Futures US-licensed warehouses; XC certified stocks reflect cocoa held in ICE Futures Europe-licensed warehouses. These are two distinct, separately published series, and the level of one does not mechanically determine the level of the other, though both respond to the same underlying global supply and demand conditions and can move in the same direction for the same fundamental reasons. The operational and geographic differences between the two certified stock systems are detailed in Section 10.3.

8. The Forward Curve Structure

CC trades in the same five delivery months per year as London Cocoa (March, May, July, September, December), and the curve shape is driven by the same crop-calendar and certified-stock dynamics described in the London Cocoa reference document. This section summarises the curve framework as it applies to CC specifically.

Zone	Contracts	Primary Driver	Typical Curve Behaviour
Front	C1–C3	US/ICE certified stocks; Ivorian/Ghanaian arrivals pace; West African weather alerts; grindings data	Can move into sharp backwardation on confirmed nearby tightness (low certified stocks, slow arrivals) or toward contango when the main crop is flowing well.
Mid	C4–C5	Crop-year transition expectations; structural demand trend; currency (EUR/USD, GHS, XOF-linked dynamics)	Reflects the market's evolving view of the upcoming crop and the prior season's S/G trajectory.
Back	C6–C8+	ICCO multi-year balance outlook; ENSO forecasts; CSSV and tree-stock trajectory; replanting investment cycles	Thin liquidity; driven by the same multi-season supply-cycle framework as the back of the London curve.

8.1 Certified Stock Thresholds and Squeeze Risk

- As with London Cocoa, when CC certified stocks fall to a low level relative to the open interest in the front contract, delivery squeeze risk on the front contract rises, creating the potential for sharp front-month backwardation. The specific certified stock level and open interest figures relevant to CC are published separately from the equivalent XC figures (see Section 10.3) and should be assessed independently when evaluating squeeze risk on either contract.
- **First notice day mechanics**: as the front CC contract approaches first notice day, non-commercial long positions must roll to the next contract or close, creating the same mechanical roll-related spread pressure described for London Cocoa — typically temporary selling pressure on the expiring front month and buying pressure on the new front month, which can briefly offset an underlying backwardation trend around the roll period.

9. Macro and Positioning Data

9.1 Commitments of Traders (COT)

- **CFTC COT for ICE Cocoa (CC)**: published weekly, covering managed money, commercial (producer/merchant/processor), and other reportable categories' net positioning. Because CC is a US-regulated, CFTC-reportable contract, this data series exists specifically for CC. Extreme net long or net short managed money positioning is generally treated as a crowding/reversal-risk indicator, consistent with the positioning framework used throughout this document series, rather than as a standalone directional signal.
- London Cocoa (XC), trading on ICE Futures Europe, is subject to a separate commitment-of-traders-style disclosure regime under UK/EU market reporting rules rather than the CFTC framework, meaning the specific positioning datasets published for CC and XC come from different regulatory regimes and are not the same dataset (see Section 10.4).

9.2 US Dollar Index (DXY) and Broader Commodity-Complex Flows

- Because CC is USD-denominated, broad US dollar strength or weakness against a basket of currencies (DXY) can affect CC in the same general direction-of-correlation sense common to most dollar-priced global commodities: USD strength tends to raise the cost of dollar-priced cocoa for non-US buyers transacting in other currencies, a modest headwind for demand at the margin, while USD weakness has the opposite effect. This is a distinct mechanism from the GBP/USD relevance specific to XC described in Section 10.2.

9.3 Speculative Fund Flows Across the Cocoa Complex

- Macro and commodity-focused funds active in cocoa frequently maintain positions across both CC and XC simultaneously, given the close fundamental linkage between the two contracts, and some participants trade the CC-XC relationship itself as a relative value position (see Section 10.5). Fund flow into or out of the broader cocoa complex — sometimes associated with broader commodity index or agricultural-sector allocation decisions — can therefore affect both contracts concurrently, even when no origin-specific or contract-specific news has occurred.

10. CC (ICE/"NYBOT") vs XC (London) — Comparison of Differences

This section catalogues every material, verifiable difference between ICE Cocoa (CC) and London Cocoa (XC). It is presented as a factual reference only — it does not take a position on which contract is "better" for any particular purpose, as that depends on the trader's currency exposure preferences, regulatory access, and specific hedging or speculative objective.

10.1 Exchange, Currency, and Contract Size

Dimension	CC ("NYBOT Cocoa")	XC (London Cocoa)
Exchange	ICE Futures US (legacy NYBOT/CSCE)	ICE Futures Europe (legacy LIFFE)
Currency	US dollars (USD)	Pounds sterling (GBP)
Quotation unit	USD per metric tonne	GBP per metric tonne
Contract size	10 metric tonnes	10 metric tonnes (identical lot size)
Minimum tick value	$1.00/MT = $10.00 per contract	£1.00/MT = £10.00 per contract
Contract months	H, K, N, U, Z (5 months/year)	H, K, N, U, Z (identical calendar structure)
Last trading day	~11 business days before month-end	Differs by several business days from CC; exact convention set independently by each exchange

10.2 Currency Exposure — The Single Largest Structural Difference

- CC is denominated in USD, meaning a CC position carries no direct GBP exposure. XC is denominated in GBP, meaning an XC position's USD-equivalent value moves with GBP/USD in addition to the underlying cocoa price move in sterling terms.
- Both contracts remain exposed to the same West African producer-currency dynamics (XOF/EUR peg in Côte d'Ivoire and the CFA zone; the floating Ghanaian cedi, GHS) because these affect the underlying physical cocoa supply regardless of which currency the futures price happens to be denominated in.
- A trader holding offsetting positions in CC and XC (a cross-market relative value position) is, by construction, also taking a GBP/USD view as part of that position, since converting one leg's currency into the other's terms requires the exchange rate.

10.3 Certified Stocks and Delivery Geography

- **CC certified warehouses**: located in the United States (historically concentrated in the New York/New Jersey port area) and at certain recognised European delivery points.
- **XC certified warehouses**: located at continental European and UK ports (historically including Amsterdam, Antwerp, Hamburg, and Felixstowe among the approved locations).
- Because the two certified stock pools are physically distinct and separately published, a change in CC certified stocks does not mechanically equal a change in XC certified stocks on a given day, even though both are drawn from and replenished by the same global cocoa supply chain over time. Physical cocoa can, subject to logistics and economics, move between being held against one contract's delivery system and the other's, which is part of the mechanism connecting the two markets (see Section 10.5).

10.4 Regulatory Regime and Positioning Data

- CC, traded on ICE Futures US, is subject to US Commodity Futures Trading Commission (CFTC) oversight, and weekly Commitments of Traders (COT) data is published for CC under the standard CFTC reporting categories (managed money, commercial, etc.).
- XC, traded on ICE Futures Europe, is subject to UK/EU market regulation (historically under the EU/UK MiFID II framework and related position-reporting requirements administered by the relevant European regulator), which uses its own reporting categories and publication schedule, distinct from the CFTC COT framework.
- A trader monitoring speculative positioning across both contracts is therefore working with two structurally different datasets, published by two different regulatory authorities under two different category definitions, rather than a single unified global cocoa positioning report.

10.5 The CC-XC Price Relationship and Arbitrage

- Because CC and XC price the same underlying global cocoa supply chain, their prices (once converted to a common currency and weight unit) are highly correlated, and the spread between them — sometimes referred to in the trade as the "New York/London arb" — is itself a tracked and, at times, traded relationship.
- Mechanically, when the CC/XC relationship (after currency conversion) moves outside its normal historical range, physical cocoa can be redirected toward the relatively higher-priced market (within the bounds of available logistics, origin differential eligibility, and transport cost), which tends to act as a moderating force on the spread over time — analogous in concept, though not in specific mechanism, to the COMEX-LME or SHFE-LME cross-exchange arbitrage relationships described for copper elsewhere in this document series.
- The drivers of a shift in the CC/XC relationship include: relative certified stock tightness in one delivery system versus the other; GBP/USD movement (which mechanically changes the GBP-to-USD converted comparison even with no change in either contract's own-currency price); and any origin-differential or quality-composition difference between what is currently being delivered/held in the two certified stock pools.

10.6 What Is Identical Between the Two Contracts

- The underlying physical commodity, origin geography (West Africa, predominantly Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana), crop calendar (main crop Oct–Mar, mid-crop Apr–Sep), weather risk factors (Harmattan, ENSO), disease risk factors (black pod, CSSV), government policy mechanisms (Ivorian DUS and farmgate pricing, Ghanaian COCOBOD forward-selling), and the ICCO global supply/demand balance sheet (including the stocks-to-grindings ratio) are all common to both contracts, because both price the same global cocoa market. Differences between the two contracts are operational, regulatory, and currency-related, not differences in the underlying physical commodity or its production geography.

11. Key Data Sources and Release Schedule

Report	Publisher	Frequency	Typical Timing	Relevance
CC certified warehouse stocks	ICE Futures US	Daily	End of day	CC-specific — front contract physical tightness signal
NCA (National Confectioners Association) grindings	NCA	Quarterly	~3–4 weeks after quarter end	North American demand — most directly relevant regional grindings report for CC
ICCO quarterly report	International Cocoa Organization	Quarterly	~6–8 weeks after quarter end	Shared with XC — global balance and stocks-to-grindings ratio
Ivorian/Ghanaian weekly arrivals	Trade services	Weekly	Mon–Wed	Shared with XC — season-defining during main crop
CFTC Commitments of Traders (CC)	CFTC	Weekly	Friday ~afternoon	CC-specific dataset under US regulatory framework
European grindings (ECA)	European Cocoa Association	Quarterly	~3–4 weeks after quarter end	Shared global demand signal — more directly tied to XC but globally relevant
ENSO forecast update	NOAA / IRI	Monthly	Mid-month	Shared with XC — back-curve supply outlook for both contracts
GBP/USD exchange rate	Reuters / Bloomberg	Continuous	Market hours	Relevant to the CC/XC relationship (Section 10.5), not to CC's own currency exposure
Ghanaian cedi (GHS) and EUR/USD	Reuters / Bloomberg / Bank of Ghana	Continuous	Market hours	Shared producer-currency dynamics affecting both contracts' underlying supply

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ICE Cocoa (CC) and London Cocoa (XC) are two currency- and exchange-distinct pricing mechanisms for a single global physical cocoa market dominated by Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana. The fundamentals governing supply — crop calendar, weather, disease, government policy — and the ICCO global balance sheet are shared in full between the two contracts. The material differences are currency denomination (USD for CC versus GBP for XC), certified warehouse geography (US/select European points for CC versus continental European and UK ports for XC), regulatory regime and positioning data (CFTC/US for CC versus UK/EU for XC), and the resulting CC-XC relative value relationship that connects the two markets through physical and financial arbitrage.

A trader using CC specifically should track the same physical fundamentals — certified stocks, arrivals pace, ICCO balance, weather and disease alerts, COCOBOD/CCC policy actions — used for London Cocoa, while additionally monitoring CC-specific certified stock levels, North American grindings data via the NCA report, CFTC COT positioning, and the GBP/USD-adjusted CC-XC spread as a distinct, trackable relative value signal.